

Industry Connect

We catch up with AMD's David Bennet to learn more about their new Ryzen lineup of CPUs

**Wear24 by Verizon**

The American telecom's new Android smartwatch will be available for \$349.99. <http://dgit.in/Wear24V>

CYBER-SECURITY IS EVERYONE'S PROBLEM

The field of cyber security is exploding with opportunities - ones that you can take advantage of



Arnab Mukherjee

arnab@digit.in

Information security is not a new topic – it is something that companies and individuals alike have been well aware of for ages. Be it the fight against viruses or ransomware, the threats and the defences have evolved side-by-side. What hasn't changed is the steadily growing need for security. It wouldn't be your fault if you assumed that there isn't any exceptional need for security professionals in the industry right now. Everything is hunky-dory and nobody is going to need even more people to keep their data (and assets) safe. So people might as well leave everything to the firewalls, VPNs and antiviruses of the world, and you most certainly don't want to be another information security analyst

in an already 'overcrowded' market. Are we getting it right so far?

Take a look at last year's attacks, which ranged from the Dyn DDoS attack that brought down half the internet or the multiple data breaches announced by Yahoo. But like many others last year and the years before them, all of these are routine far off events that haven't really boiled down to actual consequences in your life, right? Unless....

It's happening – now and here

In October 2016, Indian banks suffered their worst data breach yet when almost 3.2 million debit cards were compromised. Quite a few major banks like Axis Bank, HDFC Bank, SBI, ICICI and Yes Bank were some of the worst affected. The effect was industry wide because of the target chosen by the attackers - the interoper-

able payment system. Banks operate their ATM and payment networks in such a way that any network bank's cards will work with any bank's machine. Hence, when Yes Bank's ATM network was compromised due to a malware injection into the payment gateway of Hitachi network systems, the effect gradually spread to multiple banks and their account holders. Interestingly, the breaches happened somewhere between May and July, yet it was not until two months later in September that it was even identified. Hitachi wasn't even able to identify the amount of data breached. And that's a banking network.

Many of you might have heard of the Cloudflare data breach – infamously titled Cloudbleed due to the data leaking behaviour in the breach. Quite a few popular websites, even India based, were using Cloudflare as their